

Codex Course for David

Codex Course Part 2 - Setup and Skills

Permissions, AGENTS.md, config.toml, durable guidance, and reusable skills.

Source note: built from the DOV Codex Course - AI Wisebase Learning Pack. Official Codex source refreshed on 2026-06-29.

Module 4 - Local Files, Sandbox, Approvals, and Trust

Codex can read and edit files depending on the current permission profile. In this current session, the workspace root is writable, while access outside approved roots is restricted.

Simple rule:

- Read-only tasks are safest.
- Workspace-write tasks are normal for editing files in the project.
- Full-access or network tasks need more care.
- Destructive commands, secrets, account settings, and broad system changes should be explicit.

Practice:

Inspect this vault for Codex learning notes. Do not edit anything. Report only the paths that look relevant and what each one is for.

Then:

Create one new learning note in the best location. Keep edits scoped to that file only.

Mastery check:

- David can tell whether Codex is reading, editing, running a command, using a connector, or operating the GUI.

Sources:

- <https://developers.openai.com/codex/permissions>
- <https://developers.openai.com/codex/agent-approvals-security>

Module 5 - AGENTS.md, Config, and Reusable Guidance

Use AGENTS.md for durable repo instructions: how to run tests, what not to change, project conventions, verification steps, and review expectations.

Use config.toml for Codex settings: model defaults, sandbox profiles, MCP servers, hooks, feature flags, and other durable configuration.

Rule of thumb:

- Prompt: applies now.

- AGENTS.md: applies to this repo or folder.
- User config: applies across Codex sessions.
- Skill: reusable task workflow.
- Plugin: installable package of skills, apps, MCP servers, and related assets.

Practice:

Read the current project guidance files and summarize what instructions Codex should follow in this vault. Do not change files.

Mastery check:

- David can name the smallest durable place to store a repeated instruction.

Sources:

- <https://developers.openai.com/codex/guides/agents-md>
- <https://developers.openai.com/codex/config-basic>

Module 6 - Skills

Skills are reusable workflows. A skill is a folder with a SKILL.md file and optional scripts, references, and assets. Codex sees skill names and descriptions first, then reads the full skill only when it decides the task matches.

Use skills when:

- A workflow repeats.
- A task needs special steps or reference files.
- You want Codex to follow a known process reliably.

Practice:

Help me design a Codex skill for turning messy Obsidian capture notes into organized project notes. Ask clarifying questions first, then draft the SKILL.md.

Mastery check:

- David can explain the difference between a prompt, a skill, and a plugin.

Sources:

- <https://developers.openai.com/codex/skills>
- <https://agentskills.io>

Checkpoint Quiz 2 - Durable Setup

1. What belongs in AGENTS.md?
2. What belongs in config.toml?
3. What is a skill?
4. What is a plugin?
5. Why is MCP useful?

Answer key:

1. Durable project guidance, commands, conventions, constraints, and verification expectations.
2. Codex settings such as model defaults, sandbox profiles, permissions, MCP servers, hooks, and feature flags.

3. A reusable workflow with SKILL.md plus optional scripts, references, and assets.
4. An installable bundle that can include skills, apps, MCP servers, hooks, and assets.
5. It gives Codex structured access to tools and external context.